



Photographs by JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

CAL STATE LONG BEACH lab researcher Ryan Logan spear tags a great white shark off Huntington Beach. The trackers reveal insights into the behavior and migration of the often-misunderstood predator.

COLUMN ONE

Baby great whites swim by, but surfers stay off the menu

Lab tracking data show juvenile sharks, up to 9 feet long, often pass by SoCal swimmers with no apparent interest

By JACK DOLAN

On a cool March morning near the Huntington Beach Pier, dozens of surfers sat bobbing on their boards — legs dangling in the water, toes wiggling for warmth — and gazed with questioning eyes at the fishing boat going back and forth a few yards away, just outside the break.

From the bow of the boat, I made eye contact with several of the surfers and waved, but it was a little too far for them to hear when I shouted, “We’re tagging the great white sharks swimming around you!”

At least, I assume they didn’t hear, because they didn’t do what I would have done with that particular piece of information: slowly turn my board around, so

[See **Shark**, A8]



SHARK LAB Director Christopher G. Lowe pilots a boat as his team tracks the young sharks, whose diet consists largely of stingrays.

Voices CHRISTOPHER KNIGHT ART CRITIC

Is it time to evacuate the Getty for good?

Museum’s fire-prone locations put pieces of irreplaceable art in danger



MEL MELCON Los Angeles Times

THE GETTY FIRE burns west of the 405 Freeway as seen from the southbound side of the freeway before Getty Center Drive in 2019.

On the morning of Jan. 7, I was writing at my desk and just into paragraph 4 of a museum exhibition review when my phone pinged.

Wildfire had broken out high in the Pacific Palisades hills, and widespread evacuations were possible.

Before I had gotten to paragraph 10, another alert demanded: *Leave now.*

I was far from the danger zone, but the review I was writing was for an ancient Thracian art exhibition at the Getty Villa. I checked the online evacuation map. The Villa was squarely within its boundaries. Soon the museum was surrounded by flames and, as days went by, epic destruction unfolded for miles around.

What has been dubbed a pair of “fire hurricanes,” virtually unprecedented blazes fueled by steady winds of 70 mph with gusts over 100 mph, swept through great swaths of Los Angeles County, west and east. Over three punishing weeks, nearly 38,000 acres of homes, businesses and cultural land-

[See **Getty**, A12]

A deeper look at shootings of bystanders by L.A. police

Times analysis finds endangering passersby is rarely punished

By LIBOR JANY

Israel Hernandez heard the faint whine of sirens outside his Wilmington apartment and looked up just in time to see a minivan crash into another vehicle as police gave chase.

Two LAPD officers jumped out of their squad car and took cover behind its bulletproof doors, weapons drawn. Hernandez could hear them barking commands at the driver to come out with his hands in the air.

Instead, the suspected gang member behind the wheel stuck a handgun out of his window and squeezed off several shots in the officers’ direction. The cops returned fire.

One of the police bullets whizzed past the driver and punched through the wall of Hernandez’s second-story apartment several hundred feet away, passing in and out

of his leg.

The incident was one of at least 21 in the last decade in which LAPD officers shot a fellow cop or bystander, including three who were killed.

The police sometimes aimed at people wielding guns, knives or blunt objects — but occasionally their targets were armed with nothing at all, according to a Times analysis of more than 350 cases over the past decade in which officers fired their weapons. In more than a quarter of those incidents, police shot with citizens or other officers in their line of fire.

Looking back on the 2017 incident in which he was wounded, Hernandez said he was shocked by how nonchalant officers were about his close call.

“One of those cops comes upstairs, and he goes: ‘Don’t worry, today was your lucky

[See **Bystanders**, A10]

About-face could upend climate goals

The EPA’s plan to repeal or weaken environmental rules could deliver blow to California initiatives.

By HAYLEY SMITH

The Environmental Protection Agency’s plan to repeal or weaken more than two dozen regulations could deliver a direct blow to California policies on air and water quality standards, electric vehicle initiatives and efforts to curb planet-harming greenhouse gas emissions.

The changes announced last week are geared toward rolling back trillions of dollars in regulatory costs and hidden taxes on U.S. fam-

ilies, according to President Trump’s new EPA administrator, Lee Zeldin, who described the action on Wednesday as “the largest deregulatory announcement in U.S. history.”

But environmental groups were quick to condemn the plan as an abdication of the EPA’s responsibilities to Americans. In climate-conscious California, they say, it could reverse decades of progress.

“This isn’t just a step backward — it’s a wrecking ball aimed at decades of progress,” said Guillermo Ortiz, senior clean vehicles advocate with the Natural Resources Defense Council. “California’s leadership on clean energy and environmental justice is now directly under siege by the fed-

[See **EPA**, A12]

Trump’s use of 1798 law barred

Judge blocks president’s attempt to invoke Alien Enemies Act to speed deportations. A legal battle brews. **NATION, A6**

Building back safer after fires

Discarding past urban design practices could reduce risks to areas abutting wilderness. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 69/49. **B10**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.

Printed with soy inks on partially recycled paper.

7 85944 10300 9

ROBERT GAUTHIER L.A. Times

SHOHEI OHTANI and the Dodgers have taken Japan by storm.

Dodgers’ impact on Japan is huge

The MLB team’s presence in the baseball-crazy nation reaches into all corners of the country. **SPORTS, D1**